

THE HOUSE

Written By
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INT. COFFEE SHOP - MORNING

Brilliant morning. Coffee shop similar to a Dunkin Donuts. Mixture of people and kids going to school, etc.

MIKA BOYKO is in line. He is in his early 60s, Ukranian accent. He is annoyed and looks disapprovingly at person in front of him. The customer obviously checks phone while cashier holds out change for purchase.

MIKA

Ahem

CUSTOMER

Oh hey, thanks! Thanks!

Collects change and moves along. Mika places two dollars and one quarter on counter.

MIKA

Hi, ususal.

Mika takes coffee, finds table and sits with two friends. Older, clearly retirees.

FRIEND 1

Hey Mika, how are you doing.

MIKA

OK. Got up early, watched sun rise, and walked here. Traffic ridiculous today. Crazy. People speed like mad right by school.

FRIEND 2

Hey, how did the house go.

MIKA

I knew you would bring up. Knew it. Now is, three months, right?

FRIEND 1

(smiling)

Seems longer than that!

Mika's hands cover and rub face.

MIKA

Is not. Is just three months. Since that St. Patrick's Day nonsense. So, three months.

FRIEND 2

Oh yeah, it's been three months. To the day! Maybe. All we have to do now is count the days between stuff.

MIKA

Yah, so, I knew it was not going to be good. Knew was not going to work out well. Heh ... and it has not. It has not!

FRIEND 3

What is the house. What's that?

FRIEND 2

Oh come on ...

Mika holds up both hands as if to say all is ok

MIKA

I will explain. The house. What is the house. OK. The house is my wife's parnets. Wonderful people. You hear stories about mouter-in-law and trouble. She would do anything for you - no trouble at all.

Mika sips coffee

MIKA

She would do anything for us. Her husband, he died back in the 90s. Smoked like you would not believe. The mothe, she died in February.

FRIEND 3

Sorry about that

MIKA

Yeah, yeah. Thanks. So ... we get the house. Nona has one sister. She lives in Austinn and she tells Nona 'You sell the house. Keep the money. I lived in Austin for last 22 years - you took care of mama. You should keep it.' The sister, she got some money from the mother and did not, mind you, need to clean out all the shit from house.

FRIEND 2

You got a house my friend! A house! House partry. Easy money.

Friend 3 says in passing

FRIEND 3

Austin ...

MIKA

Yeah, easy money. And Austin is OK
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 place. Visited my sister-in-law
 there four or five times. Visted
 twice in Juyly. Crazy. Hot, hot,
 hot. Cannot leave house in daytime,
 could only leave at night. Reminded
 me of Egypt where people in the
 summer can only go outside at
 tnight.

Mika pauses for more coffee

MIKA
 Coffee is weak today. Who make
 this! Ok, so, that is alll good.
 All fine. Sister OK with
 everything. Wife OK with
 everything. All we need to do is
 sell house, get money, move on.

Immediately break

INT. KITCHEN OF AN OLDER TUDOR HOME. MIKA IS INSIDE WITH
 HIS WIFE NONA. NONA IS IMPECCABILY DRESSED. SHE IS
 BEAUTIFUL. BOTH SIT AT THE KITCHEN TABLE. FOR SOME
 REASON NONA IS EATIN A SAUSAGE MCMUFFIN.

MIKA
 All he have to do is sell the house.
 Put it on the market. Set a
 reasonable price, I know what that
 price is, and we are good.

NONA
 I know. I know! we can see the
 house and then, we can think about a
 condo in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA
 I keep telling you - there is no way
 we can get a anything good in Ft.
 Lauderdale for the price we can get
 for this house no way -

NONA
 (finishing McMuffin)
 You keep saying that. But you are
 not looking hard enough. I see these
 shows. I see the Beachfront
 Bargins, they find these things all
 the time. I will find something,
 let me look.

MIKA
 You can look all you want. All you
 want. I will not stop you from
 (MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 doing that. Dowload the app, search
 Ft. Lauderdale. There is nothing to
 had for \$200 thousand. Not even
 close. Its just ... its not even
 realistic!

NONA
 Exactly, because you do not let me
 look. You are not looking right.

Mika shakes head, exhales, and looks away.

MIKA
 Let's just sell this thing first.
 Please. Let's do that. Then we can
 argue about Ft. Lauderdale.

NONA
 Yes, let's talk about the house. I
 know exactly what we need to do.

MIKA
 Good, good. Consensus. I know too.

NONA
 Really, you know what to do. You
 have read my mind and know. Really.

MIKA
 Yes, I have. I have looked at the
 prices. Houses, comprables.

Nona shaiking head
 NONA
 Comprables.

MIKA
 Yes. Yes. We should put a good
 price on the house. Go \$240K or
 \$245K to start and get offers. Move
 it out.

NONA
 Really. That is what we should do.

MIKA
 Yes. Really.

NONA
 (smiling confidently) This is what
 we are going to do.

MIKA
 No ... no.

NONA

We are going to use Mikey Drogai.

MIKA

No, no. Why. No. Why? Why Mikey?

NONA

Beacuse, he is a real estate agent. He knows how to sell a house. And he knows how to get the best price. And we know his family.

MIKA

Oh great! Great. So you are providing the precise reasons we should not go with Mikey. What if things go wrong.

NONA

What do you mean, wrong?

MIKA

Mikey is not bale to the house, he listens to you and prices it waty to high, and he get exactly no one interested and looking that the house. I know this kid, we know this kid, we know exactly what he is capable of.

NONA

He sold Mideas house. Two weeks. Two weeks and the house was sold. We will have no problems. None.

MIKA

Oh come on. Midra's house was perfect. Perfect. Updated kitchen, huge yard, you could fit three cars in that garage. I could have sold that house. Easy to do. Your parent's house, this house, not easy.

NONA

(smiling). No. No. This house is perfect. It is great. There will be no problems.

MIKA

It is not great. Not gret. Not not great. Its good, its a good house, yes. But it has problems.

NONA

Like what?

MIKA

Like the fact the kitchen is out of a 1970s Reader's Digest advertisement. Like the fact there are three bathrooms with pink tiles. Pink tiles. Like the fact every square inch of flooring that is not bathroom is carpeting from the 1980s

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NONA

(Smiling) You can stop now. I do not need to listen to this. This house, this house, is perfect. It will sell. Besides, I have already called Mikey.

Mika surprised

MIKA

How? When? Why did you do this and not ask me?

NONA

Uh, because, I do not need your permission. Is my house. I make the decisions.

MIKA

You do not need my permission that is not what I said.

NONA

Sure sounded like it.

MIKA

Not my permission, just my advice.

NONA

There is some difference between the two?

MIKA

Yes, of course. Of course there is. I would have told you 'Mikey, I don't think he is a good choice.' I see realtors online, I think I know which ones are good. We get that flyer from the Spencer woman, she seems like she knows how to sell a house.

NONA

Well (laughing) we meet Mikey tomorrow.

MIKA

When?

NONA

4PM at my parent's house.

MIKA

Opportunity to discuss?

NONA

Nope. Do you want more coffee.

MIKA

Please ... yes.

EXT. MIKA IS OUTSIDE A PLAIN LOOKING HOUSE BUILT IN THE EARLY 1970S. HE LOOKS AT HIS WATCH WHICH READS 4:20. A LARGE 4 DOOR BACK BMW WITH TINTED WINDOWS WHEELS IN. VANTIY PLAT WITH DROGAI2 PULLS IN. MIKEY STEPS OUT. HE IS TALL, CLOSE TO 6'2. HE IS NICE LOOKING AND WEARS GRAY SLACKS WITH TAN TRENCH COAT. HE SETS CUP OF COFFEE ON TOP OF CAR AS HE TAKES OFF SUNGLASSES. HE THEN CONFIDENTLY WALKS TO MIKA, CARRYING AN ATTACHE CASE.

MIKEY

(booming voice) Mika! Nona! It is so good to see you!

Mikey moves in for a hug and a giddy Nona goes over for an embrace.

NONA

Oh Mikey, so glad you can help! So great. How are you! How is everything!

MIKEY

Oh Non, it could not be better. Could not be better! Look!

Mikey gestures to BMW and then goes to shake hands with MIKA

MIKA

You are late. 20 minutes. Late.

MIKEY

Ohhhh, so sorry. So sorry. I had to take the kids to hockey practice. It went late. I wanted to call but I only had your home number and figured you would already be here.

MIKA

And yet you have coffee.

MIKEY

(Walking with Nona) Yeah, they sell it at the rink. What did we do here!

NONA

Don't worry about being late. We have nothing to do. Look, I cleaned up the orn of the house.

MIKEY

Oh every littel bit helps Nona. Every little bit. This, this, this is a great house. Great house!

MIKA

Yes, good house. Not great though. But good.

MIKEY

No, no, do not undersell this house. This (looking at the house) is a great house.

Mikey makes a gesture with his hand as though taking a picture.

NONA.

See! I keep telling him it is great Mikey but he will not listen. He will not listen.

MIKEY

Don't worry Nona, we'll win him over

(both start laughing)

MIKEY

I already know the price for the house.

MIKA

What? How the hell do you know the price for this house. You haven't step foot in here, in, what 17 years? Again, how the hell do you know?

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I know real estate! I know this stuff. I looked at the pictures on Google Maps. I know the exact price.